

Even if and even though

Learner workbook

Distinguish a condition from an accepted fact.

Understand the distinction

Even though introduces a fact accepted in the sentence: Even though it was raining, we walked. Even if introduces a condition or possibility that does not change the result: Even if it rains, we will walk.

The if clause does not assert that the condition is true. It can refer to a possibility or something already known in context; its job is conditional. For a likely future condition, normally use present tense after if rather than will.

Compare the patterns

ACCEPTED FACT

Even though I was tired, I stayed.

The speaker says they were tired.

CONDITION

Even if I am tired, I will stay.

The plan holds whether or not I am tired.

CONTRAST

It was expensive, but I bought it.

But can express a simpler contrast.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. Which asserts rain occurred: Even if it rained / Even though it rained?

2. Complete: Even if she ____ late, we will wait. (arrive)

3. Does Even if the shop is closed, I will go prove it is closed?

Use it in your own life

Write a plan that will remain the same under a possible difficulty.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. Even though it rained.

Even though presents the rain as a fact.

2. arrives

Use present simple for this future condition.

3. No. The closure is treated as a condition.

The sentence does not establish its truth.

One possible response

Even if the weather is bad, I will go to class.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-32.html